

Hari Prasad Gridharan

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EDUCATION

CORNELL UNIVERSITY, SC JOHNSON COLLEGE OF BUSINESS

Ithaca, NY

THE CHARLES H. DYSON SCHOOL OF APPLIED ECONOMICS AND MANAGEMENT

Expected May 2029

Candidate for Bachelor of Science in Applied Economics and Management, Minor in Artificial Intelligence

Dyson Scholar (top 10% of academic class) 2025-2026

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ADOBE

Remote

AI/Strategy Consultant (Contract)

January 2026 - Present

- Conducting competitive analysis of AI tools and workflows across model training, performance metrics, and market adoption
- Researching data privacy, model performance, governance, and IP protection framework for enterprise deployment contracts
- Developing strategic brief on model-optimized architecture and services for board presentation, supporting IT leadership

NATIONAL SPEECH AND DEBATE ASSOCIATION

Greenwood Village, CO

Tournament Manager and Judge

September 2023 – December 2025

- Oversaw and worked at regional tournaments, organized for 900+ competitors and 30+ schools, set up fee collection systems
- Utilized Speechwire, Tabroom, and MS365 Suite to ensure smooth communication and tournament organization
- Judged 200+ rounds of debate, providing constructive feedback, and being elected to judge break and finals rounds

PROJECTS

SOCIAL NETWORK PREDICTION MARKET PLATFORM

Ithaca, NY

Co-founded Project

September 2025 - Present

- Developed prediction market platform from concept to MVP; ranked top 10% among 20,000+ Y Combinator applicants
- Architected full-stack application, prediction methods, novel check, backend, and PostgreSQL database management systems
- Conducted market sizing analysis, competitive landscape assessment of 15+ platforms, and developed unit economics model

AI-POWERED CLIMATE STARTUP DISCOVERY ENGINE

Ithaca, NY

Independent Project

December 2026 – January 2026

- Engineered NLP pipeline processing 10,000+ startup descriptions using BERT embeddings and custom classification system
- Developed multi-factor scoring algorithm incorporating patent analysis, founder backgrounds, and market trend signals
- Deployed semantic search system enabling sub-second retrieval of similar companies across 50+ climate tech verticals

OPEN-SOURCE LLM COST OPTIMIZER

Ithaca, NY

Independent Project

December 2025 – January 2026

- Created a Python toolkit to minimize LLM API expenses via intelligent model selection, prompt tuning, and semantic cache
- Engineered a cache layer leveraging sentence-transformers and Redis to eliminate duplicate LLM requests and token costs
- Developed a robust benchmarking framework to evaluate GPT-4, Claude, and Gemini for performance and cost efficiency

ON-CAMPUS EXPERIENCE

CORNELL ENTREPRENEURSHIP CLUB

Ithaca, NY

Developer

September 2025 - Present

- Engineered high-risk experimental projects: ML applications and analysis, full-stack website platforms, geospatial analysis
- Organized YC speaker series, managed logistics (150+ attendees), partnered with unicorn founders and venture-backed startups
- Generated 150,000+ views on Instagram/LinkedIn through speaker content, event advertising, and technical project showcases

CORNELL DIGITAL TECH AND INNOVATION (DTI)

Ithaca, NY

Business Analyst

November 2025 - Present

- Developed content strategy and marketing materials for product initiatives serving 15,000+ Cornell students
- Conducted market analysis and developed strategic recommendations for digital product enhancements, such as search routing
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to optimize user experience and drive engagement metrics across digital platforms

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Programming & ML: Python (NumPy, pandas, scikit-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow), SQL, JavaScript, React, Redis, Embeddings

Business & Data: Financial Modeling, Market Sizing, Competitive Analysis, Statistical Analysis, Excel, PowerPoint

Interests: Cliff-Jumping, Hiking 14,000ft Mountains, Singing Indie and Carnatic Classical Music, Cooking Regional Indian Cuisine